# 8-Week A1 German Roadmap

**Daily commitment:** 1–2 hours | **Starting point:** Complete beginner (Urdu native speaker)

**Goal:** Reach A1 level in 8 weeks — enough German to introduce yourself, handle basic daily conversations, and have a solid foundation to move into A2.

**Daily structure to follow every day (adjust order to your mood):**
- 20–30 min: New grammar/vocab lesson (Urdu-medium YouTube course or Nicos Weg) - 15–20 min: Duolingo (repetition + habit) - 15–20 min: Anki flashcard review (spaced repetition — start this Week 1, non-negotiable) - 10–20 min: Listening practice (Easy German clips once you hit Week 3+) - Sunday: Light review day, no new material, just revise the week

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## Week 1 — Foundations

**Goal:** Alphabet, pronunciation, greetings, "to be," basic pronouns

- Day 1: German alphabet, pronunciation rules (w, v, z, j, ei, ie, ä/ö/ü/ß)
- Day 2: Greetings — Hallo, Guten Morgen/Tag/Abend, Auf Wiedersehen, Tschüss
- Day 3: Personal pronouns (ich, du, er/sie/es, wir, ihr, sie/Sie)
- Day 4: Verb "sein" (to be) — ich bin, du bist, er ist…
- Day 5: Introducing yourself — "Ich heiße…", "Ich komme aus…", "Ich bin … Jahre alt"
- Day 6: Numbers 0–20
- Day 7: Review + start Anki deck with all Week 1 vocab (~40 words)

**Home Practice (Week 1):** - Write out the alphabet by hand, 3x, saying each letter aloud - Record yourself saying: "Hallo, ich heiße [name]. Ich komme aus Pakistan." - Make 20 Anki flashcards (word + gender where relevant) from this week's vocab - Count out loud 0–20 three times without looking - Fill-in exercise: Write "ich ***, du*** , er ___" (bin/bist/ist) five times from memory

## Week 2 — Basic Grammar Core

**Goal:** Present tense regular verbs, der/die/das intro

- Day 8: Verb "haben" (to have) — full conjugation
- Day 9: Regular verb conjugation pattern (-e, -st, -t, -en, -t, -en) with machen, spielen, lernen
- Day 10: der/die/das — intro to the 3 genders (memorize gender WITH each noun from now on)
- Day 11: Plural noun forms (basic patterns)
- Day 12: Numbers 21–100
- Day 13: Days of the week, months
- Day 14: Review + Anki + mini self-test (write 10 sentences about yourself)

**Home Practice (Week 2):** - Conjugate 5 regular verbs (machen, spielen, lernen, wohnen, kaufen) fully, all 6 forms, by hand - Sort 20 nouns into der/die/das columns from memory, then check against Anki - Write your phone number, age, and today's date out in German words - Say the days of the week forward and backward out loud, 3x each

# Week 3 — Questions & Daily Life

**Goal:** Question formation, family, daily routine vocab

- Day 15: W-questions (Wer, Was, Wo, Wann, Warum, Wie)
- Day 16: Yes/No questions (verb-first word order)
- Day 17: Family vocabulary (Familie, Mutter, Vater, Bruder, Schwester…)
- Day 18: Telling time (Wie spät ist es?)
- Day 19: Daily routine verbs (aufstehen, frühstücken, arbeiten, schlafen)
- Day 20: Start Easy German (YouTube) — watch 1 short clip with subtitles
- Day 21: Review + Anki + record yourself answering 5 W-questions about your life

**Home Practice (Week 3):** - Write 6 questions (one per W-word) about a friend, then answer them yourself - Draw your family tree and label each member in German - Write out your full daily routine as a timeline with clock times in German - Watch one Easy German clip twice — first without subtitles, then with — note 5 new words

# Week 4 — Akkusativ Case (Key Milestone)

**Goal:** Understand and use the accusative case — this is where German starts feeling “real”

- Day 22: What is a case? Why German has them (Urdu speakers: think of it like postposition logic)
- Day 23: Akkusativ articles (den, die, das, die — how der/die/das change)
- Day 24: Akkusativ with common verbs (haben, essen, trinken, sehen)
- Day 25: Food & drink vocabulary
- Day 26: Ordering food practice sentences (“Ich möchte einen Kaffee, bitte”)
- Day 27: Negation (nicht vs. kein)
- Day 28: Review + Anki + write a short paragraph using Akkusativ

**Home Practice (Week 4):** - Rewrite 10 Nominativ sentences into Akkusativ (change der/die/das → den/die/das where needed) - Write a restaurant order dialogue (5-6 lines) ordering 3 food/drink items - Fill-in exercise: “Ich habe ___ Bruder” / “Ich sehe ___ Frau” (fill correct article) - Negate 8 sentences correctly choosing nicht vs. kein

# Week 5 — Dativ Case & More Verbs

**Goal:** Dative case basics, modal verbs intro

- Day 29: Dativ articles (dem, der, dem, den)
- Day 30: Common Dativ verbs (helfen, gefallen, gehören)
- Day 31: Modal verbs intro — können, müssen, wollen
- Day 32: Modal verb conjugation + sentence structure (modal + verb-to-end)
- Day 33: Shopping vocabulary + numbers/prices practice
- Day 34: House & rooms vocabulary
- Day 35: Review + Anki + speaking practice (describe your room out loud)

**Home Practice (Week 5):** - Write 5 sentences using Dativ verbs (helfen, gefallen, gehören) about people you know - Conjugate können, müssen, wollen fully and write 2 example sentences per verb - Roleplay a shopping trip — write out prices and a short buyer/seller dialogue - Describe every room in your house in German, 2-3 sentences each, then record yourself saying it

# Week 6 — Past Tense & Connectors

**Goal:** Perfekt (past tense) intro, joining sentences

- Day 36: Perfekt tense — haben/sein + past participle (intro concept)
- Day 37: Common past participles (gemacht, gegessen, gegangen, gewesen)
- Day 38: Talking about yesterday — “Gestern habe ich…”
- Day 39: Connectors — und, aber, oder, weil, denn
- Day 40: City/places vocabulary (Bahnhof, Supermarkt, Schule…)
- Day 41: Directions — “Wo ist…?”, “Geradeaus, links, rechts”
- Day 42: Review + Anki + write about “Gestern” (yesterday) — 5 sentences

**Home Practice (Week 6):** - Make a table of 15 verbs with their Perfekt participles, memorize haben vs sein pairing - Write your full “yesterday” as a paragraph using Perfekt tense (8-10 sentences) - Combine 8 pairs of simple sentences using und/aber/oder/weil/denn - Draw a simple map and write directions from your house to the nearest market in German

# Week 7 — Real Conversation Practice

**Goal:** Combine everything, build speaking confidence

- Day 43: Weather vocabulary + talking about weather
- Day 44: Hobbies & free time (Freizeit)
- Day 45: Health basics — “Mir geht es gut/schlecht”, body parts
- Day 46: Full mock conversation: introducing yourself + small talk (write it out, then say it aloud)
- Day 47: Listening practice — 2 Easy German clips, note new words
- Day 48: Try a language exchange app (Tandem/HelloTalk) — first short chat with a native speaker
- Day 49: Review + Anki + full self-recorded 1-minute intro about yourself

**Home Practice (Week 7):** - Describe today’s weather + your favorite season, 4-5 sentences - List your top 3 hobbies and write why you like each, one sentence per reason - Write a full mock conversation (8-10 exchanges) meeting someone new, then perform it out loud - Have one real (even short) written or voice chat on Tandem/HelloTalk this week

# Week 8 — Consolidation & Mock Test

**Goal:** Fill gaps, simulate A1 exam, lock in retention

- Day 50: Full grammar review — sein, haben, regular verbs, modals
- Day 51: Full case review — Nominativ, Akkusativ, Dativ side by side (make a comparison chart)
- Day 52: Vocabulary review — go through ALL Anki cards, mark weak ones
- Day 53: Take a free online A1 mock test (Goethe-Institut website has sample tests)
- Day 54: Review mistakes from mock test, target weak areas
- Day 55: Writing practice — write a full paragraph (80-100 words) about yourself, your family, your studies
- Day 56: Final review + reflect: you’ve completed A1. Plan your A2 start date.

**Home Practice (Week 8):** - Build a one-page cheat sheet: all case articles (Nominativ/Akkusativ/Dativ) side by side - Take the free Goethe A1 mock test under timed conditions, score yourself honestly - Rewrite your weakest mock-test section from scratch after reviewing the correct answers - Final paragraph (80-100 words): “Das bin ich” — about yourself, family, and studies — then read it aloud and record it

## Non-negotiables throughout all 8 weeks

1. **Anki every single day** — even 10 minutes. This is what makes vocabulary stick long-term.
2. **Always learn nouns WITH their gender** (der/die/das) — never learn a noun alone.
3. **Speak out loud daily**, even alone. Silent learning doesn't build real fluency.
4. **Don't skip review days (Sundays)** — they're what convert short-term memory into long-term.

## Sources & Links

- **Urdu-medium course:** YouTube — search "A2 German Course - Learn German for Free in Urdu" (covers A1/A2, made for Pakistani/Urdu-speaking learners)
- **Structured lessons (A1–B1):** DW Nicos Weg — https://learngerman.dw.com/en/overview (Deutsche Welle's free official course, video + grammar + exercises)
- **Daily habit app:** Duolingo — https://www.duolingo.com
- **Flashcards (spaced repetition):** Anki — https://apps.ankiweb.net
- **Listening practice:** Easy German (YouTube channel) — https://www.youtube.com/@EasyGerman
- **Alternative beginner course:** smarterGerman (YouTube channel) — free A1 video course
- **Language exchange (speaking practice):** Tandem — https://www.tandem.net | HelloTalk — https://www.hellotalk.com
- **Mock A1 test:** Goethe-Institut sample exams — https://www.goethe.de/en/spr/kup/prf.html